simplicity, a lessening of vulgarity and ostentation, and a feeling of unity with the masses. The lower middle classes no longer tried to ape the richer classes in the matter of clothes or feel humiliated in their cheaper attire. Indeed they felt not only dignified but a little superior to those who still flaunted silks and satins. Even the poorest felt something of this dignity and self-respect. It was difficult in a large khadi-clad gathering to distinguish between the rich and the poor, and a spirit of camaraderie grew up. Khadi undoubtedly helped the Congress to reach the masses. It became the uniform of national freedom.

Khadi also became a check on the ever-present tendency of the mill-owners to raise the prices of their stuffs. These mill-owners in India were only kept in check in the past by foreign competition, especially that of Lancashire. Whenever this competition ceased, as during the World War, cloth prices soared up in India to extraordinary heights and vast sums were made by the Indian mills. The swadeshi and foreign-cloth boycott movements later on also helped these mills greatly, but the presence of khadi made a difference and prices could not go up as high as they might otherwise have done. Indeed the mills exploited the khadi sentiment of the people (and so did Japan) by manufacturing coarse cloths which were almost indistinguishable from the hand-spun and hand-woven article. In the event of another emergency arising, like a war, resulting in a stoppage of foreign cloth, it is unlikely now that the Indian mill-owners will be able to exploit the consumers to the extent they did from 1914 onwards. The khadi movement will prevent that, and the khadi organisation has the capacity in it to spread out at short notice.

In spite of all these present-day advantages of the khadi movement in India it seems to me after all a transitional affair. It may continue even later on as an auxiliary movement easing the change-over to a higher economy. But the main drive in future will have to be a complete overhauling of the agrarian system and the growth of industry. No tinkering with the land, and a multitude of commissions costing lakhs of rupees and suggesting trivial changes in the superstructure, will do the slightest good. The land system which we have is collapsing before our eyes, and it is a hindrance to production, distribution and any rational and large-scale operations. Only a radical change in it, putting an end to the little holdings and introducing organised collective and co-operative enterprises, and thus increasing the yield greatly with much less effort, will meet